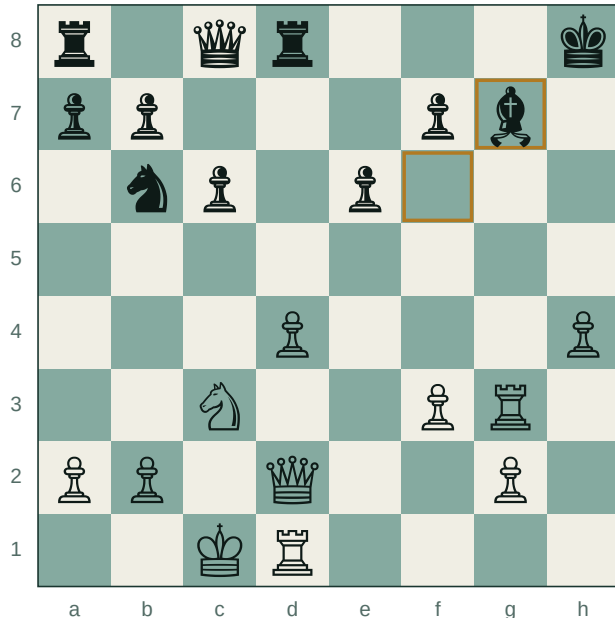


Mate in three: White, move 23

Mate in three

White to move



Previous move: 22...Bxg7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Qg5 Rg8 24. Qh5+ Bh6+ 25. Qxh6#

23.Qg5 The queen moves from d2 to g5. From g5 it attacks rook on d8 and bishop on g7. Recorded reply: **23...Rg8**.

24.Qh5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on g3 attacks the bishop on g7. Recorded reply: **24...Bh6+**.

25.Qxh6# Mate: queen on h6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

HOW TO LOOK

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.